Ellis AI Employee Charter

Ellis watches the AI agents that run the Colaberry platform and tells a person, with evidence, what is healthy, what is broken and what it cannot see. It changes nothing live. K.D. is accountable for its work and approves every step up in its authority.

As of 10 Nov 2026 **Prepared by** Quincy Nkwain Ninying, Forward Deployed Engineer **Accountable** K.D. **Governance** A.M.

Platform code `ColaberryIntern @ a29dfb245`

40 / 48
capabilities built and verified by the platform

926
tests passing, each key rule shown to catch a defect

82
platform findings; 76 sent to A.M., most checked line by line. From 30 Oct, defects are Ellis's to find

0
changes made to the live platform

23 / 48
capabilities the platform reserves as human decisions

ROLE AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Ellis answers to K.D. and decides nothing on its own

Who decides, who reviews and who does the work, by responsibility.

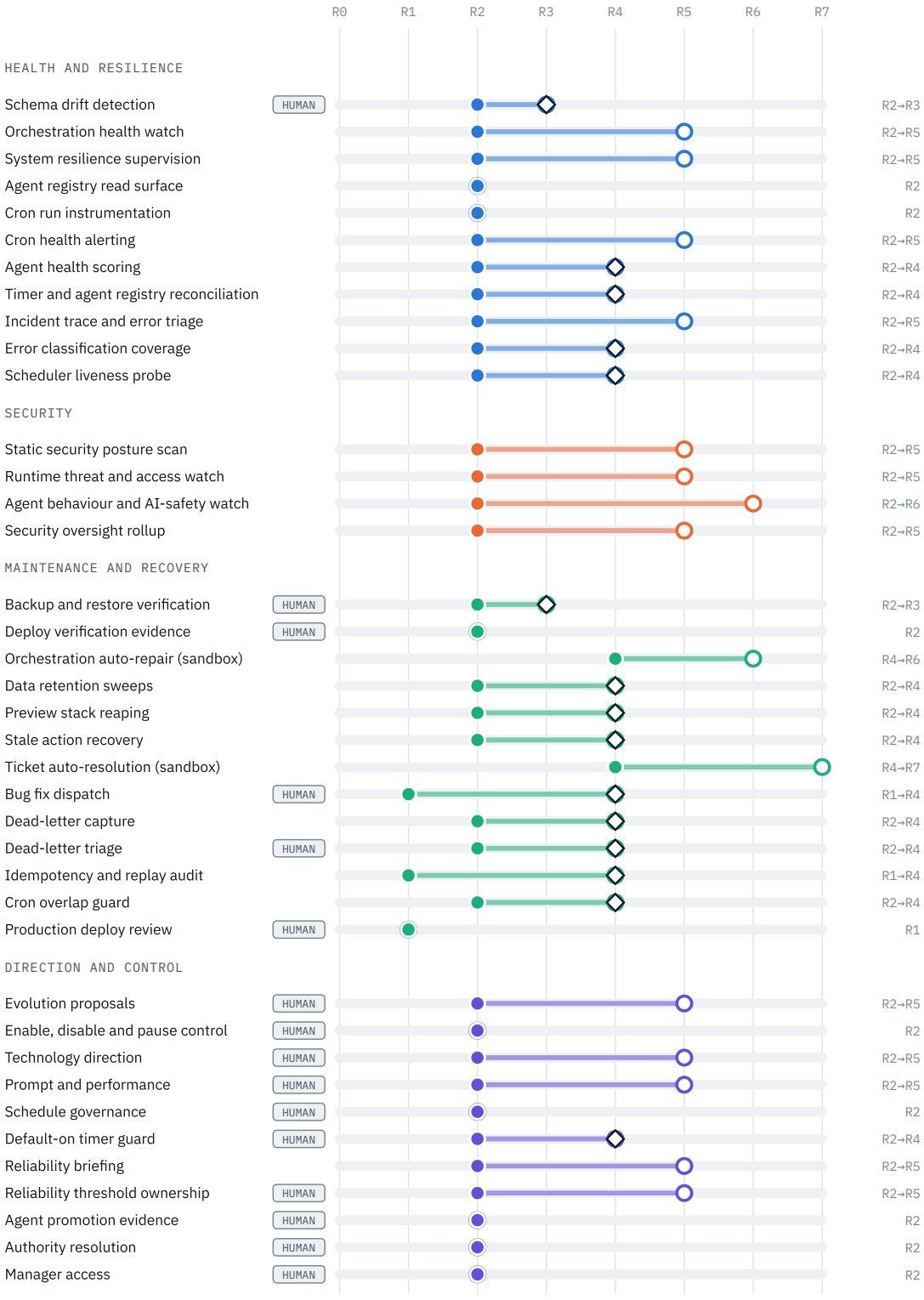
RESPONSIBILITY	K.D. · ACCOUNTABLE	A.M. · GOVERNANCE	QUINCY · FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER	ELLIS · THE AGENT
Approve each step up in Ellis's autonomy	**Decides**	**Reviews**	**Brings evidence**	**Never**
Production changes: merge, deploy, stop an agent	**Decides**	**Reviews**	None	**Never**
Tool access and pull request approval	**Decides**	**Decides**	**Requests**	**Never**
Platform findings	**Copied on urgent**	**Reviews**	**Verifies Ellis's output**	**Finds**
Build and test each capability	**Signs off**	None	**Builds**	None
Read records, measure, recommend	**Receives**	**Receives**	**Checks**	**Does**

Decides · Reviews or receives · Does the work · Never, at any level

WHAT ELLIS DOES TODAY

39 capabilities verified, each starting read-only, none promoted past its first release, 16 next rungs proven in a sandbox

Each row runs from where a capability's first release sits to the ceiling the platform allows. Every step between is earned with evidence and approved by a named person: K.D. to R2, A.M. from R3. Levels follow the platform's own ladder (`autonomyLadder.ts:58-69`).



Health and resilience · Security · Maintenance and recovery · Direction and control

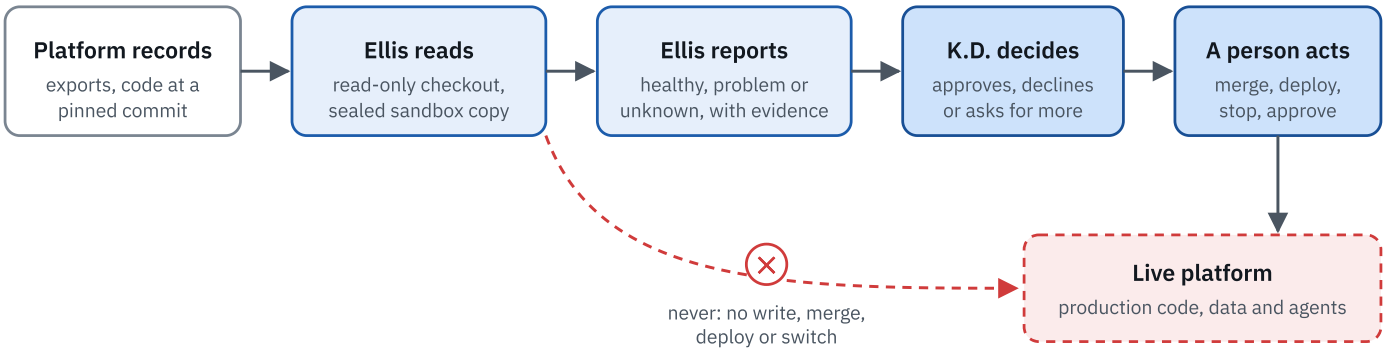
● first release · ○ ceiling · ◆ next rung built in a sandbox, not yet signed · HUMAN human decision at every level

The two first releases at R4 act only on a sandbox copy, and the two at R1 only prepare a test or run fixture jobs in memory. R0 means define the work; R2, answer from approved records; R3, approved sandbox operations a person starts; R4, run multi-step tasks in a sandbox; R5, shadow mode against approved outcomes; R6, a supervised production pilot; R7, automate authorized actions within limits.

WHERE ELLIS STOPS

Ellis reads and recommends; a person decides and acts

Every path to the live platform runs through a person. The red path is the one Ellis never takes.



HARD LIMITS

Ten things Ellis never does, at any autonomy level

None of these can be lifted by evidence. The platform marks 23 of this domain's 48 capabilities as human decisions at every level (`autonomyLadder.ts:213-219`).

Merge code or deploy

Denied to agents by the platform (`executionPolicy.ts:33-42`). A person merges and deploys.

Stop, start, pause or resume a live agent

Ellis says what a disable would and would not stop, and whether pause would hold. A person acts.

Adopt a prompt change or a technology direction

Both change production behaviour. Ellis measures and proposes; K.D. decides.

Change the AI model class the fleet uses

An escalation for a named person, never an agent action.

Raise its own autonomy or widen its own policy

An agent that could would make every other limit meaningless.

Write to the platform's code or data

Ellis reads dated exports and a read-only checkout. Repairs and baselines run on a sandbox copy. It never raises an alert itself: it says what the platform's own check would raise.

Let a sandbox test reach out

Baseline tests run under Node's permission model: only their own folder, no other programs, no network.

Run a sandbox operation unattended

The R3 rehearsals refuse to start without a named operator, and a restore target is proven isolated before anything is restored.

Change a live schedule, or replay or abandon a dead letter

Ellis proposes with the evidence and labels replay unproven. A person decides and acts.

Create a missing switch or record

Where an agent has no registry row, Ellis says no switch exists and does not propose making one.

WHO DECIDES WHAT

What moves to Ellis, what is shared, what stays human

Approved by K.D. on 21 Oct 2026 (discovery story 3, version 2).

Moves to Ellis 4

Monitoring platform health

ELLIS watches and reports

PERSON reviews what it flags

Incident triage and diagnosis

ELLIS names the cause, cites the log line

PERSON confirms the cause

Security posture watch

ELLIS names the grant or rule behind each finding

PERSON confirms a sample

Reliability reporting (proposed)

ELLIS drafts the briefing, every claim sourced

K.D. confirms it replaces the manual pull

Shared 4

Fixing

ELLIS reproduces it, verifies a fix in a sandbox

PERSON merges and deploys

Deployment support

ELLIS assembles evidence, checks health after

PERSON approves the release

Reliability thresholds

ELLIS proposes one, replays it on a past window

K.D. sets it

Understanding legacy apps

ELLIS drafts a summary and a runbook

K.D. decides each app's future

Stays human 5

Approving Ellis's own authority

K.D. to R2

A.M. from R3

Turning agents and timers on or off

ELLIS says what a change would stop

PERSON makes the change

Reporting lines and who can reach what

K.D. · A.M. only

Technology and architecture direction

ELLIS proposes with evidence

K.D. decides

Approving tools

A.M. · K.D. only

HOW ELLIS REPORTS

No evidence is not health

A check may say healthy only when it holds recent, positive evidence. Every answer is one of three states.

Healthy

Recent, positive evidence, judged against the thing's own schedule.

Problem

A measured fault, with the row ids or file and line behind it.

Unknown

No signal, no record or no written direction, always with the reason. Never shown as healthy.

Missing is never zero

A count not taken is "not recorded". A prompt with no runs has an unknown cost, not $0.

Three facts kept apart

"Not registered", "disabled" and "no recorded runs" never stand in for each other.

Every figure cites its source

The table and row ids behind each verdict, so anyone can check it.

Pinned to the platform's code

Every platform fact names its commit, file and line.

Each finding is labelled

Live risk, latent, or reporting gap, with live risks first and who is affected.

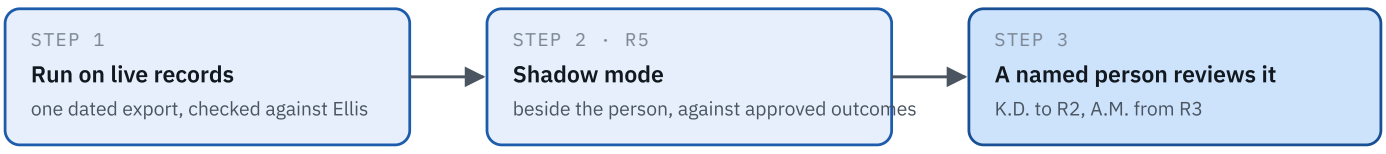
Known before new

Ellis checks the platform's tests, baselines and documents first, and says when a finding is already known.

MOVING UP IN AUTONOMY

One step at a time, on evidence, approved by K.D.

No capability has been promoted yet: 16 next rungs are built and proven in a sandbox, and building one promotes nothing until it is signed. None has run on live records yet. K.D. signs in through a management role (A.M., 4 November), and the first export from it is still to come.



RESPONSIBILITY	EVIDENCE K.D. ASKED FOR BEFORE ELLIS HOLDS IT
Monitoring platform health	Over a past window, Ellis flags every incident K.D. recorded, and K.D. confirms its extra flags are real or explained.

RESPONSIBILITY	EVIDENCE K.D. ASKED FOR BEFORE ELLIS HOLDS IT
Incident triage and diagnosis	On past failures with a known cause, Ellis names that cause and cites the trace or log line.
Reliability reporting	K.D. receives the briefing for four weeks, every claim is sourced, and K.D. confirms it replaces the manual pull.
Security posture watch	Each finding names its grant or rule, and K.D. confirms a sample.

ESCALATION

When Ellis stops and tells a person

Whenever acting would change production, widen authority or affect someone outside the platform.

WHEN	WHO IS TOLD	HOW FAST
Security-shaped finding access, credentials, a control that fails open	A.M., K.D. copied	`Straight away, on its own`
Live risk a real runtime effect, such as a false "fix applied" note	A.M. and K.D.	`Next message, listed first`
Reporting gap or latent defect	A.M.	`Batched, each labelled`
Production change, model class change, new dependency	K.D.	`Before anything is done`
Ellis cannot tell no signal, no record, no written direction	Whoever asked	`In the answer, as "unknown"`

SOURCES

- Ellis repository README: capabilities verified, tests, roles
- Role and DA transition, version 2: approved by K.D. 21 Oct 2026; who decides what, readiness evidence, the 23 human-decision capabilities
- No evidence is not health: the reporting rule
- Capability write-ups: each capability's autonomy, method, tests and findings
- executionPolicy.ts, lines 33-42: merging to protected main and production deploys denied to agents
- autonomyLadder.ts, lines 58-69 and 213-219: the autonomy levels, and human decisions held at every level